Superintendent's Report

School District No. 1J, Multnomah County, Oregon
Regular Board Meeting of February 28, 2005
AGENDA

1. Announcements/Celebrations
2. Recognition of Employees with Ten or More Years of Service to Portland Public Schools
3. Report on Success of Principal For A Day
4. Financial Accountability
   - Update on Board Consideration of Local Option Levy and General Obligation Bond
   - Second Reading of Policies
     - 5.60.060-P Administrative Employees' Terms of Employment
     - 8.30.010-P District Funds for Purchase of Meals and Refreshments for Meetings
5. Academic Accountability
   - Superintendent's Proposal for New Graduation Requirements
   - Superintendent Discusses Proposed School Closures and Changes
6. Business Agenda
7. Adjourn

INFORMAL MINUTES
Regular Board Meeting, February 28, 2005

The regular meeting of the Board of Directors came to order at 6:30 PM on the above date at the call of Co-Chair David Wynde in the Auditorium of the Blanchard Education Service Center, 501 North Dixon Street, Portland, Oregon.

There were present:

Board of Directors:
David Wynde, Co-Chair
Bobbie Regan, Co-Chair
Julia Brim-Edwards
Derry A. Jackson, Sr. -- *absent*
Douglas Morgan
Lolenzo Poe -- *absent*
Dilafruz Williams -- *absent*

Student Representative:
Suleima Cortez

Staff:
Vicki L. Phillips, Superintendent
Jollee Faber Patterson, General Counsel/Board Secretary
Julie Joel, Executive Assistant, Board of Education

1. ANNOUNCEMENTS/CELEBRATIONS

Co-Chair Wynde reviewed the agenda for the evening.

National Black History Month

Director Brim-Edwards announced that February was National Black History Month. She said the celebration dated back to 1926 and was credited to a Harvard scholar named Carter G. Woodson. Mr. Woodson chose the second week of February in honor of the birthdays of pivotal Black supporters – Frederick Douglass and Abraham Lincoln. In closing, Director Brim-Edwards offered a quote: "Success is to be measured not so much by the position that one has reached in life as by the obstacles which were overcome while trying to succeed."

Read Across America

Student Representative Cortez said Read Across America was initially created as a one-day event to celebrate reading on Dr. Seuss' birthday, March 2nd. She said the National Education Association's Read Across America has grown into a nationwide initiative that promotes reading every day. Portland Public Schools has opportunities at most schools for readers. She specifically noted the need for readers at Tubman Middle School. If you are interested in a particular school, please contact the principal.

Legislative Update

Co-Chair Regan thanked organizers of the rally to Salem that was held on Monday, February 21st. She specifically thanked Stand for Children and the many students, staff and parents who joined Board members to rally at the state capitol in Salem.

Co-Chair Regan explained that both the Local Option Levy and the General Obligation bond expire in June 2005 and the temporary county income tax will expire in June 2006. She said if the levy and bond were put on the May 2005 ballot, both would require a double majority to succeed. Board members continue to meet with legislators from the Portland area and continue to push for stable funding for K-12 education.

Sad News

Director Morgan expressed the Board's deepest sympathy to the family and friends of Eddie Barnett, Jr., a junior at Grant High School, who died the previous week while playing a basketball game at Madison High School. He said Grant Principal Toni Hunter met with staff before the arrival of students the day after Eddie's death and a safe room was in place the remainder of the week for students. Toni Hunter wanted to specifically thank Superintendent Phillips, Harriet Adair, Pam Wilson and the PPS Communications Department, with a special thanks to Lew Frederick for his work with the media. Director Morgan said Ms. Hunter also acknowledged the tremendous outpouring of support from School District staff and students to Grant High School and Eddie's family. He announced that a memorial service is planned for Eddie on Tuesday at the Portland Community College gymnasium.

Replays

Co-Chair Wynde announced the replays of the February 14, 2005 meeting can be viewed on Channel 28 on:

Wednesday, March 2, 2005	9:30 PM
Friday, March 4, 2005	10:00 AM and 8:30 PM
Saturday, March 5, 2005	7:30 PM
Sunday, March 6, 2005	4:00 PM
Monday, March 7, 2005	8:00 AM

2. **RECOGNITION OF EMPLOYEES WITH TEN OR MORE YEARS OF SERVICE TO PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS**

Co-Chair Wynde thanked the School District employees who were listed in the Board Book for service to Portland Public Schools (from ten years to twenty-five years). He said PPS employees work to better the lives of students in many ways.

The Board and Superintendent Phillips honored those employees who were present and asked them to come forward and receive a token of appreciation and best wishes from the Board and Superintendent.

3. **REPORT ON SUCCESS OF PRINCIPAL FOR A DAY**

Co-Chair Wynde noted Principal For A Day activities on February 2, 2005 brought 117 business and community leaders into 97 PPS schools and program sites.

Director Morgan said he visited schools that had a higher than average student turnover rate, higher numbers of English Language Learners and a higher number of students on the free and reduced lunch program. He said even though those schools he attended had the most significant challenges, they did well. He expressed the Board's deep gratitude for the work of principals, teachers and all staff in PPS schools for the great job they do every day.

Co-Chair Wynde recognized the Principal For A Day presenting sponsor, Comcast, and the media sponsor, The Business Journal, along with the founding partner, Portland Schools Foundation, the Jubitz Family Foundation, and especially Al Jubitz.

Jan Wierima, PPS Partnership Coordinator, said three-fourths of the participants this year were first-timers. She thanked everyone for their participation.

Curt Henniger, Comcast, said he spent the day at Roosevelt High School. He noted Comcast supports several initiatives on the Roosevelt campus, including the Step-Up computer lab and the teen parent facility. He said he had a very positive experience at Roosevelt, and Comcast was honored to be a part of Principal For A Day.

Co-Chair Regan recognized Jayme Armstrong, who is leaving the Portland Schools Foundation, for all her work in support of schools and especially for the role she played in Principal For A Day over the past four years. She is leaving the Foundation to direct development work for the Aurora Chorus.

The Board Co-Chairs and Superintendent presented framed photographs by Grant High School second year art students (Judi Brandel, teacher) to: Jayme Armstrong; Curt Henniger, Theressa Davis, Shannon Grosswiler, Cynthia Guyer, Craig Wessel (not all recipients were in attendance).

4. **FINANCIAL ACCOUNTABILITY**

Update on Board Consideration of Local Option Levy and General Obligation Bond

Co-Chair Wynde said five years ago voters approved a property tax levy, the Local Option, which provided incremental funding for Portland Public Schools. He noted the levy was intended to be an enhancement for basic school funding. He said the General Obligation bond is for improvements to buildings owned by Portland Public Schools. He noted both the levy and bond will expire in June 2005. Co-Chair Wynde said last week the Board had a work session on the subject of the feasibility of going to the voters in May to renew both the levy and bond.

Superintendent Phillips said for the 2005-2006 school year, without the Local Option and if the legislature approvers the governor's budget of $5.2 billion, Portland Public Schools will have a $59 million shortfall. She noted the following school year, when the temporary county income tax runs out, that shortfall is predicted to be $98 million. The Superintendent said the community has allowed PPS to maintain stability, but the governor's budget would have PPS facing a large deficit.

Mark Wiener, community activist, said he is a Portland Public Schools parent who has worked on a number of local funding measures, including the original Local Option levy campaign, the Ballot Measure 26-48 campaign and also worked to defeat the repeal measure. He said because of the double majority rule, which states 50% of the registered voters must vote in order for a measure to pass, it was his opinion that it will be impossible to pass a measure any time in 2005. He said more citizens registered to vote due to the presidential election in 2004 and that made the double majority rule harder to clear. Mr. Wiener added newly registered voters were motivated by the presidential election or single ballot issues.

Cynthia Guyer, Executive Director of the Portland Schools Foundation, urged everyone who is concerned about the funding gap in K-12 education to put all their energy together and join with the state PTA, Stand for Children and other education advocates to get the governor's proposal up to $5.4 billion. She said the Foundation would support the Superintendent and Board in creating more efficiencies within the budget to get a higher performing district.

Shannon Campion, Portland Metro Director of Stand for Children, said the biggest challenge faced when looking at renewal of the Local Option levy and General Obligation bond is the double majority. She said it was her

belief that Portlanders supported schools, but the need to meet the double majority would be extremely challenging. Ms. Campion said Stand for Children feels their energy will be better spent lobbying the state legislature to increase the educational budget to $5.4 billion and support Representative Hunt's bill to eliminate the double majority rule.

Scott Bailey, President of Children and Parents for Public Schools (CPPS), said he also has worked with PPS on a number of quality of education initiatives. He said he agrees with the analysis and if he thought there was a chance to win in May, CPPS would do the hard work needed to pass the measure; however, he did not feel it was possible due to the double majority rule.

Co-Chair Regan said the Board would vote at their March 14th School Board meeting on whether to place the Local Option Levy and/or the General Obligation bond on the May ballot.

Superintendent Phillips said the Local Option funds almost 200 teaching positions.

Director Brim-Edwards requested a one-page handout that would show the impact of the Local Option funds on schools and specifically, quantify school by school, so the public can see where the Local Option funds were spent.

Superintendent Phillips responded Ms. Franklin sent a Power Point presentation out to school principals, but she would add Director Brim-Edward's request to that information so principals would have it at the school level, and it would also be posted on the PPS website.

Co-Chair Wynde noted he wanted to make it clear that the primary responsibility for funding K-12 education in the state lies with the governor and the legislature.

Second Reading of Policies

Administrative Employees' Terms of Employment (5.60.010-P):

Director Brim-Edwards said the adoption of this policy would clean up the senior administrators' contract process. She noted there were a handful of contracts that contained special perks – payments for cars, golden parachutes – and not all were performance-based contracts. She said she personally felt that was outrageous and noted there were times when the School Board did not see contracts prior to voting on them. She said the new policy provides a great level of accountability and transparency.

Director Brim-Edwards said the policy establishes uniform health insurance benefits, offers no housing allowances or car allowances and further the policy provides Board-approved salary schedules.

Co-Chair Regan thanked Director Brim-Edwards for pursuing the policy and further thanked Superintendent Phillips for moving forward in this area.

Director Brim-Edwards noted the one issue still outstanding as early retirement.

The Board unanimously approved Board Action 3225, "Adoption of Board Policy on Administrative Employees' Terms of Employment" by a vote of 4-0 (Directors Jackson, Poe and Williams absent from voting; Student Representative Cortez voting yes, unofficial).

District Funds for Purchase of Meals and Refreshments for Meetings (8.30.010-P)

Co-Chair Regan introduced the resolution to approve the policy and briefly explained the policy.

The Board unanimously approved Board Action 3224, "Adoption of Board Policy on District Funds for Purchase of Meals and Refreshments for Meetings" by a vote of 4-0 (Directors Jackson, Poe and Williams absent from voting; Student Representative Cortez voting yes, unofficial).

5. ACADEMIC ACCOUNTABILITY

Superintendent's Proposal for New Graduation Requirements

Superintendent Phillips noted the graduation requirements proposal will be brought before the Board at their meeting of March 28, 2005 with a First Reading of the Graduation Requirements Policy.

Steve Olczak, Director of Secondary Education, provided a Power Point presentation (a copy of this document is available in the Board Support Office). The proposal would include the following credit requirements and would begin with the Class of 2009:

- 4 English
- 3 Social Studies (Global/American Studies and Government/Economics)
- 3 Mathematics (including Algebra and Geometry applications)

3 Science (Physical Science and Biology, plus a Science credit that supports the student's education plan)
2 Wellness
1 Pathway Focus
3 Credits or more aligned with Pathway Core
1 Senior Pathway Portfolio/Project
5 Elective credits

25 Total Credits

Director Morgan asked that three assumptions by addressed be the Student Achievement Committee and brought back to the Board: 1) the target date for getting the plan up and running for the class of 2009; 2) the percentage of students in the School District expected to meet CIM/CAM requirements; and 3) what type of professional development will be needed.

Director Brim-Edwards asked if the new graduation requirements would align fully with the Oregon University system, with the exception of two years of foreign language, and noted the importance that every student graduating from PPS should be able to attend a public university.

Mr. Olczak responded 51% of 2004 graduates took two or more years of a foreign language. He said it would be helpful if PPS could build capacity at the middle school level for a second language.

Director Brim-Edwards asked who would grade the efficiency of the work samples.

Mr. Olczak responded teachers and the School District would have a major commitment over the next four years to have the bulk of the teachers trained.

Superintendent Phillips added that the School District would have to address the issue of teacher work loads and an array of other issues in order to implement the new graduation requirements.

Citizen Comment

Nina Showell -- Grant High School sophomore

Superintendent Discusses Proposed School Closures and Changes

Superintendent Phillips said she would put forth her final recommendations on school closures and changes next week, following the conclusion of the hearings. She said the resolution that will be prepared regarding the Rieke-Hayhurst boundary alignment would be clear that the change would take place the following year. She said regarding the possible closure of Smith Elementary, the resolution would state that PPS would keep the property. Superintendent Phillips stated she was not recommending any changes to the Ash Street or Richmond proposals. Regarding the proposals for the Jefferson cluster, the Superintendent said she would spell out the safety measures for seventh and eighth graders that would be put in place for the 7-12 structure at the hearing at Jefferson next week. Superintendent Phillips said once decisions were made by the Board, detailed implementation plans would be announced.

Citizen Comment

Jim Grant – Smith
Julie Poust – Edwards
Julie Yeggy – Abernethy
Veisa Loving – Tubman
Lindell Stone – Tubman
Charles Bishop – Jefferson Cluster
Ron Popkin – Jefferson Cluster
Rose Murdock – K-6 structure
Darian Fuller – Transfer Concerns
Angela Pack – Jefferson Cluster
Robin Rolfe – Jefferson Cluster
Elizabeth Callison – Smith
Ray Streinz – Smith
Randall Heeb – Edwards
Tony Carr -- Edwards

Co-Chair Wynde stated there would be a hearing held at Hosford Middle School on March 1st and at the Jefferson Campus on March 3rd. He said the Board will consider actions at their March 14th School Board meeting on: closure of Edwards Elementary and merger with Abernethy Elementary, closure of the Richmond Neighborhood School, the Rieke-Hayhurst boundary alignment, the Ash Street boundary alignment, and the closure of Smith Elementary. All remaining recommendations will be considered at the March 28th School Board meeting.

6. **BUSINESS AGENDA**

Ms. Joel noted a change to Board Action 3218. The Board unanimously approved the remaining items of the Business Agenda by a vote of 4-0 (Directors Jackson, Poe and Williams absent from voting; Student Representative voting yes, unofficial).

7. **ADJOURN**

Co-Chair Wynde announced the next regular meeting of the Board of Education will be held at on Monday, March 14, 2005, at 6:30 PM in the Auditorium of the Blanchard Education Service Center.

The regular meeting of the Board of Education for February 28, 2005 adjourned at 9:30 PM at the call of Co-Chair David Wynde.

Submitted by:

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Julie Joel, Executive Assistant
PPS Board of Education